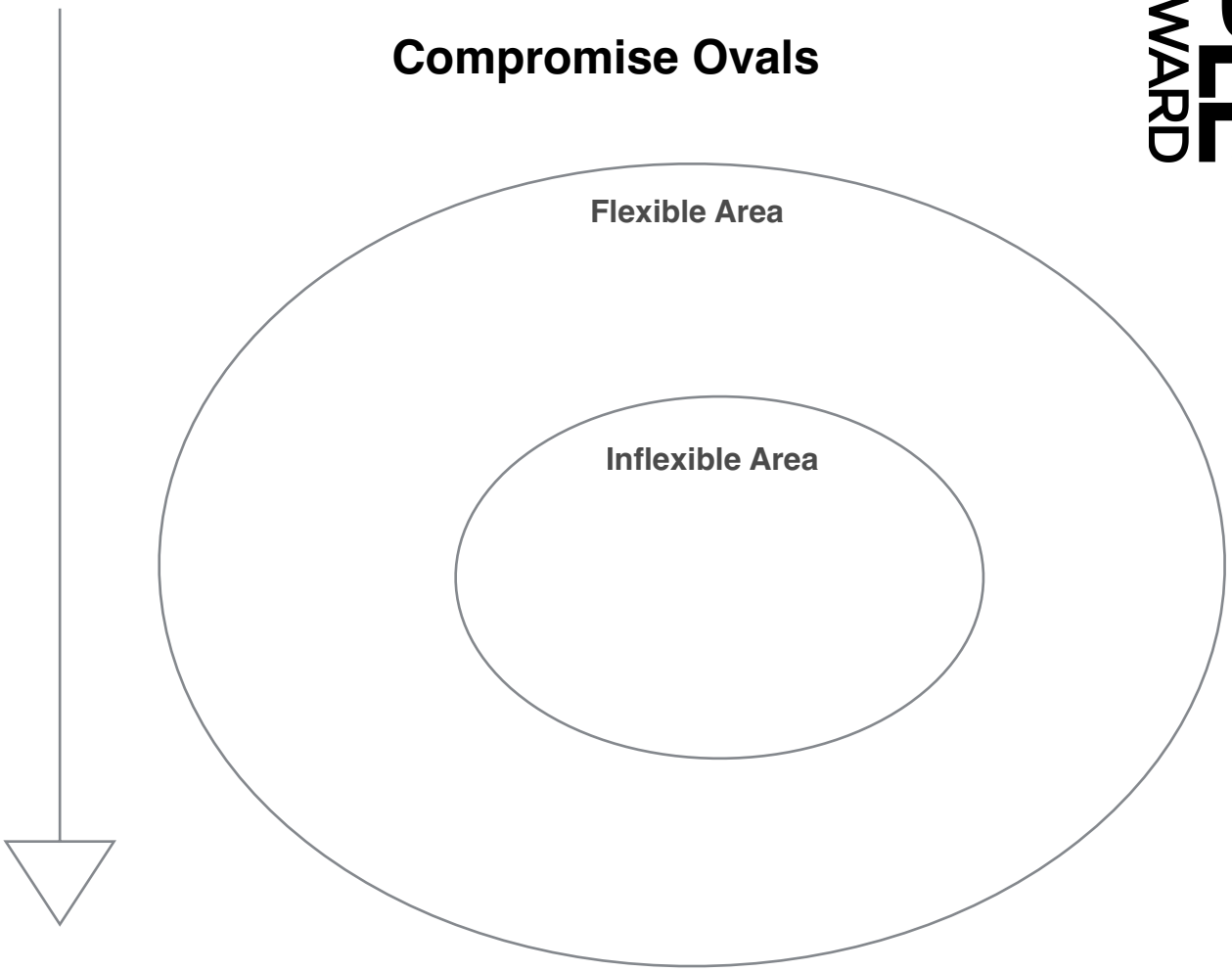
<u>The Art of Compromise</u>:

1. Define the minimal core areas that you cannot yield on (areas of inflexibility). Try to keep this area as small as possible. See the compromise of those below.
2. Define your areas of greater flexibility. Try to make this area as large as possible.
3. Now work on coming up with a temporary compromise by discussing the questions below. Then you can evaluate your compromise after a time and see where you are on the problem later.

Compromise Ovals



My inflexible area or core need on this issue is:

My more flexible areas on this issue are:

Our compromise that honors both our needs and dreams is:

Getting to "yes". Discuss these questions with your partner:

- Help me understand why your inflexible area is so important to you.
- What are your core feelings, beliefs or values about this issue?
- Help me understand you're flexible areas.
- What do we agree about?
- What are common goals?
- How might these goals be accomplished?
- How can we reach a temporary compromise?
- How can I help me you're core How can we reach a temporary compromise?
- How can I help meet you're core needs?